

# Clint Claessen

University of Freiburg, Department of Political Science, Belfortstraße 20, 79098 Freiburg im Breisgau, Germany

## PERSONAL AND CONTACT DETAILS

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|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Full name  | Clint Claessen                                                    |
| Email      | clint.claessen@politik.uni-freiburg.de                            |
| Homepage   | <a href="https://clintclaessen.com">https://clintclaessen.com</a> |
| LinkedIn   | clint-claessen                                                    |
| BlueSky    | @Clint0475.bsky.social                                            |
| Twitter/ X | @Clint0475                                                        |

## CURRENT POSITION

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| 10/2026 - Present | <b>Postdoctoral Researcher</b><br>INCONEX ERC project, Department of Political Science, University of Freiburg, Germany |
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## EDUCATION

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|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 08/2020 - 06/2026 | <b>University of Basel, Switzerland</b><br>PhD in Political Science<br><i>Summa Cum Laude</i>                              |
| 01/2018           | <b>University of Amsterdam, Netherlands</b><br>MSc in Teacher Training Social Studies<br><i>Cum Laude, GPA: 8.6 / 10</i>   |
| 01/2016           | <b>ETH Zurich, Switzerland</b><br>MA in Comparative and International Studies<br><i>Insigni Cum Laude, GPA: 5.57 / 6.0</i> |
| 07/2013           | <b>University of Amsterdam, Netherlands</b><br>BSc in Political Science<br><i>Cum Laude with Honours, GPA: 8.6 / 10</i>    |

## PREVIOUS ACADEMIC POSITIONS AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 06/2025 - 09/2026 | <b>Postdoctoral Researcher</b><br>INCONEX ERC project, Salzburg Centre of European Union Studies (SCEUS), University of Salzburg, Austria |
| 05/2022 - 08/2022 | <b>Visiting Scholar</b><br>Department of Political Science, Carleton University, Ottawa, Canada                                           |
| 01/2022 - 04/2022 | <b>Visiting Scholar</b><br>Data Science Institute, London School of Economics, United Kingdom                                             |
| 09/2021 - 12/2021 | <b>Visiting Scholar</b><br>Data Science Lab, Hertie School, Berlin, Germany                                                               |
| 01/2020 - 08/2020 | <b>Research Assistant</b> , PCC Project<br>University of Basel, Switzerland                                                               |
| 04/2018 - 10/2019 | <b>Shift Supervisor</b> , Starbucks - Britnell Books<br>Toronto, Canada                                                                   |

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|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01/2017 - 01/2018 | <b>High School Teacher</b> , Social Studies<br>Huizermaat, Huizen, The Netherlands  |
| 04/2015 - 02/2016 | <b>Research Assistant</b> , Prof. Stefanie Bailer<br>ETH Zurich, Switzerland        |
| 02/2015 - 06/2015 | <b>Teaching Assistant</b> , Prof. Josette Bear<br>University of Zurich, Switzerland |

## PUBLICATIONS IN PEER-REVIEWED JOURNALS

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| 2026 | Don't Look up: Evaluating the Tradeoff Between Performance and Sustainability of Text Classification Using Open LLMs, with <i>Sean Hamilton-Palicki</i> and <i>Isaac Bravo</i> . <i>Social Science Computer Review</i> , OnlineFirst. <a href="#">[link]</a> |
| 2026 | Ambition and access: Linking regional opportunity structures and career-ambitious youth party members, with <i>Stefanie Bailer</i> and <i>Tamaki Ohmura</i> . <i>Party Politics</i> , OnlineFirst. <a href="#">[link]</a>                                    |
| 2026 | Moderation or Amplification? Mapping Speech Distinctiveness Among Green Parties Using a Machine Learning Approach, with <i>Denise Traber</i> and <i>Martijn Schoonvelde</i> . <i>Legislative Studies Quarterly</i> , 51(3). <a href="#">[link]</a>           |
| 2025 | Picture-perfect: The relationship between party leader visibility and voting during party leader elections, with <i>Maxime Walder</i> . Accepted at <i>Visual Communication Quarterly</i> .                                                                  |
| 2024 | Accruing Career Capital: How Party Leaders with More Political Experience Survive Longer, <i>Party Politics</i> , 30(4): 719-735. <a href="#">[link]</a>                                                                                                     |
| 2021 | The Winners of Legislative Mandate: An Analysis of Post-Parliamentary Career Positions in Germany and the Netherlands, <i>European Journal of Political Research</i> , 60(1): 25-45, with Stefanie Bailer and Tomas Turner-Zwinkels. <a href="#">[link]</a>  |

## WORKING PAPERS

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|      |                                                                                                                                  |
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| 2025 | Risen to the Top, but Put at a Disadvantage: Examining the Role of Career Capital in Gendered Party Leaders' Political Survival. |
| 2025 | Populist Leaders' Pragmatism: Investigating the Role of Party Leaders in Populist Rhetoric.                                      |

## AWARDS

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| 2018 | National NVLM-Prize for Best Series of Lessons in Social Studies <a href="#">[link]</a> |
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## RESEARCH AND TRAVELING GRANTS

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| 50,400 CHF | Doc.Mobility for the project ' <i>Party Leaders' Pathways to Power</i> ' - Collecting and analyzing data on party leaders careers, September 2021 - August 2022, at various institutions, granted by the SNF                  |
| 2,600 CHF  | Travel Grant to present 'A Career Catalyst: Youth Wings and Party Leaders' Gendered Political Survival at the ECPR General Conference in Prague and the SISP in Genoa, by the FAG, Freiwillige Akademische Gesellschaft, 2023 |
| 1,500 CHF  | Travel Grant to present 'At the Top against Odds: Career Capital in Gendered Party Leaders' Survival' at the American Political Science Conference in Philadelphia - by the FAG, Freiwillige Akademische Gesellschaft, 2024   |

## PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES AND SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

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|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Reviewer                    | Journal of Politics, Comparative Political Studies, European Journal of Political Research, Party Politics, European Journal of Gender and Politics, European Union Politics, Swiss Political Science Review, Scandinavian Political Studies, Journal of Diversity and Gender Studies, Parliamentary Affairs, EPJ Data Science, Politics and Governance, Austrian Journal of Political Science, CPSS Conference 2024/2025 |
| Representative<br>Mittelbau | Representing non-professorial teaching staff, Department of Social Sciences, University of Basel, 2022-2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

## INVITED TALKS AND INVITED WORKSHOPS

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- Colloquium: Department of Political Science, University of Innsbruck on the 27th of January, 2026
- Workshop: Open-Source Large Language Models for Behavioral Science at the Faculty of Psychology, University of Basel on the 11th of February, 2025
- Workshop: Analysing Faces with Images as Data (online), scholars for Ukraine on the 25th of July, 2024
- Colloquium: Department of Political Science, University of Vienna on the 25th of March, 2024
- Workshop: Analysing Faces with Images as Data at COMPTTEXT 2023, Glasgow
- The Conference on Political Careers, at the University of Basel, in the panel 'Political Pathways' on June 20, 2022
- DSI Unstructured Data Session, at the London School of Economics, on the 14th of March, 2022
- Internal LSE Colloquium in London, at the Data Science Institute on the 16th of February, 2022
- CIVICA PhD Panel (online) on the 'Governance and Democracy in the Digital Era', on the 11th of October, 2021
- The Empirical Political Science in Progress (EPSIP) colloquium at the Humboldt University (online), on the 18th of November, 2021

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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|              |                              |
|--------------|------------------------------|
| EPSS         | 2026                         |
| EPSA         | 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025 |
| APSA         | 2022, 2024                   |
| CPSA         | 2022, 2024                   |
| ECPR Parl.   | 2016, 2021, 2023, 2025       |
| ECPR General | 2021, 2023, 2024, 2025       |
| ECPR JS      | 2023                         |
| COMPTTEXT    | 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026       |
| SVPW         | 2020, 2023, 2024, 2026       |
| AuPSA        | 2025                         |
| SISP         | 2023, 2024, 2026             |
| PSAI         | 2021, 2025                   |
| GraPa        | 2021                         |

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Supervision            | 10x Seminar Papers, University of Basel                                                                                                                                   |
| Spring 2025<br>& 23/21 | BA Seminar: From Party Members to Party Leaders: Selecting the Party Executive, University of Basel [ <i>Evaluation 2025, 2023, 2021</i> ]                                |
| Fall 2024              | BA Course: Analyzing Politicians' Social Media with Data Science, University of Basel [ <i>evaluation</i> ]                                                               |
| Spring 2024            | BA Seminar: The 2024 Presidential Election: An Introduction to US Political Parties and Their Candidate Selection Process, University of Basel [ <i>evaluation</i> ]      |
| Fall 2023              | BA Seminar: Unlocking Social Media: Investigating Image-based Political Communication during Elections through Applied Methods, University of Basel [ <i>evaluation</i> ] |
| Spring 2023            | BA Seminar: From Party Members to Party Leaders: Selecting the Party Executive, University of Basel [ <i>evaluation</i> ]                                                 |
| Fall 2022              | BA Seminar: Introduction to the Political System of the United States: The 2022 Midterm Elections, University of Basel [ <i>evaluation</i> ]                              |
| Fall 2020              | BA Seminar: The 2020 Presidential Election: An Introduction to the United States and its Electoral Process, University of Basel [ <i>evaluation</i> ]                     |
| Spring 2015            | MA Tutorial: Tutorial for Prof. J. Baer's Course: The Legitimizing of Empire. Nikolai Ia. Danilevskii's Russia and Europe, ETH Zurich                                     |

## ADDITIONAL TRAINING

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### Substantial

|      |                                                                                                                       |
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| 2021 | Writing for Publication in the Social Sciences and Humanities, University of Basel                                    |
|      | <u>Advanced Methods</u>                                                                                               |
| 2023 | Visual Analysis, ECPR Winter School                                                                                   |
| 2021 | Natural Language Processing with Deep Learning, XCS224N, Stanford Online                                              |
| 2020 | Regression Analysis II, Maximum Likelihood Estimation I and Mathematics for Social Scientists II, ICPSR Summer School |
| 2020 | Machine Learning, Text Analysis, ECPR Winter School                                                                   |

### Academic Teaching and Learning

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|---------|-----------------------------------------|
| 06/2023 | Bystander Training, University of Basel |
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## PUBLIC OUTREACH: INTERVIEWS AND MEDIA CONTRIBUTIONS

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|                        |                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Political Science Blog | Does political experience matter for the success of party leaders? <i>In: LSE EUROPP Blog, 5th of October, 2023</i>                                            |
|                        | Is there really a revolving door between politics and business? (with Stefanie Bailer and Tomas Turner-Zwinkels) <i>In: LSE EUROPP Blog, 9th of June, 2020</i> |
|                        | De Parlementaire 'baantjescarrousel': feit of fictie? (with Stefanie Bailer and Tomas Turner-Zwinkels) <i>In: StukRoodVlees, 7th of April, 2020</i>            |

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| News/Radio | <p>Rechtspopulist Geert Wilders gewinnt Wahlen in den Niederlanden <i>In: SRF 10-vor-10, Switzerland, 23rd of November, 2023</i></p> <p>Koolmees naar NS: Bewijst dit het bestaan van een Haagse baantjescarousel? <i>In: Radio 1, The Netherlands, 11th of October, 2022</i></p> <p>Angriff auf das 'Haus der Demokratie' <i>In: Telebasel, Switzerland, 7th of January, 2021</i></p> |
| Events     | U.S. Election Night in Atlantis, Basel. <i>Co-Organizer</i> . See TeleBasel, Switzerland, 5th of November, 2024                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

## LANGUAGE SKILLS

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|          |        |
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| Dutch:   | Native |
| English: | Fluent |
| German:  | C2     |

## COMPUTING SKILLS

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| Data Science: | R, Python                            |
| Other:        | OBS, L <sup>A</sup> T <sub>E</sub> X |

## REFERENCES

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|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Prof. Dr. Stefanie Bailer     | <p>Professor of Comparative Politics<br/>Universität Basel<br/>Department of Political Science<br/>Bernoullistrasse 14/16, 4056 Basel, Switzerland<br/>Email: stefanie.bailer@unibas.ch<br/>Tel: +41 61 207 13 81</p>                 |
| Prof. Dr. Denise Traber       | <p>Associate Professor of Political Sociology<br/>Universität Basel<br/>Department of Political Science<br/>Bernoullistrasse 14/16, 4056 Basel, Switzerland<br/>Email: denise.traber@unibas.ch<br/>Tel: +41 61 207 60 54</p>          |
| Prof. Dr. Ken Benoit          | <p>Dean of the School of Social Sciences and<br/>Professor of Computational Social Science<br/>Singapore Management University<br/>School of Social Sciences<br/>Singapore 179873<br/>Email: kbenoit@smu.edu.sg</p>                   |
| Prof. Dr. Martijn Schoonvelde | <p>Assistant Professor of European Politics &amp; Society<br/>University of Groningen<br/>Chair group Politics and Society<br/>Oude Kijk in 't Jatstraat 26, 9712 EK Groningen, Netherlands<br/>Email: martijn.schoonvelde@rug.nl</p> |

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